



Chapter 11: Resume Templates

A template is great help in getting started with a resume. It's good practice to start with a tried and proven template, then customize it to your own style and preferences. In this section, we'll review popular templates among developers—and analyze them with pros, cons and ways to improve the template, should you choose to use it.

There is no such thing as a perfect template. And a template is not worth much without great content—content that you will need to write.

Resume Generators vs Resume Templates

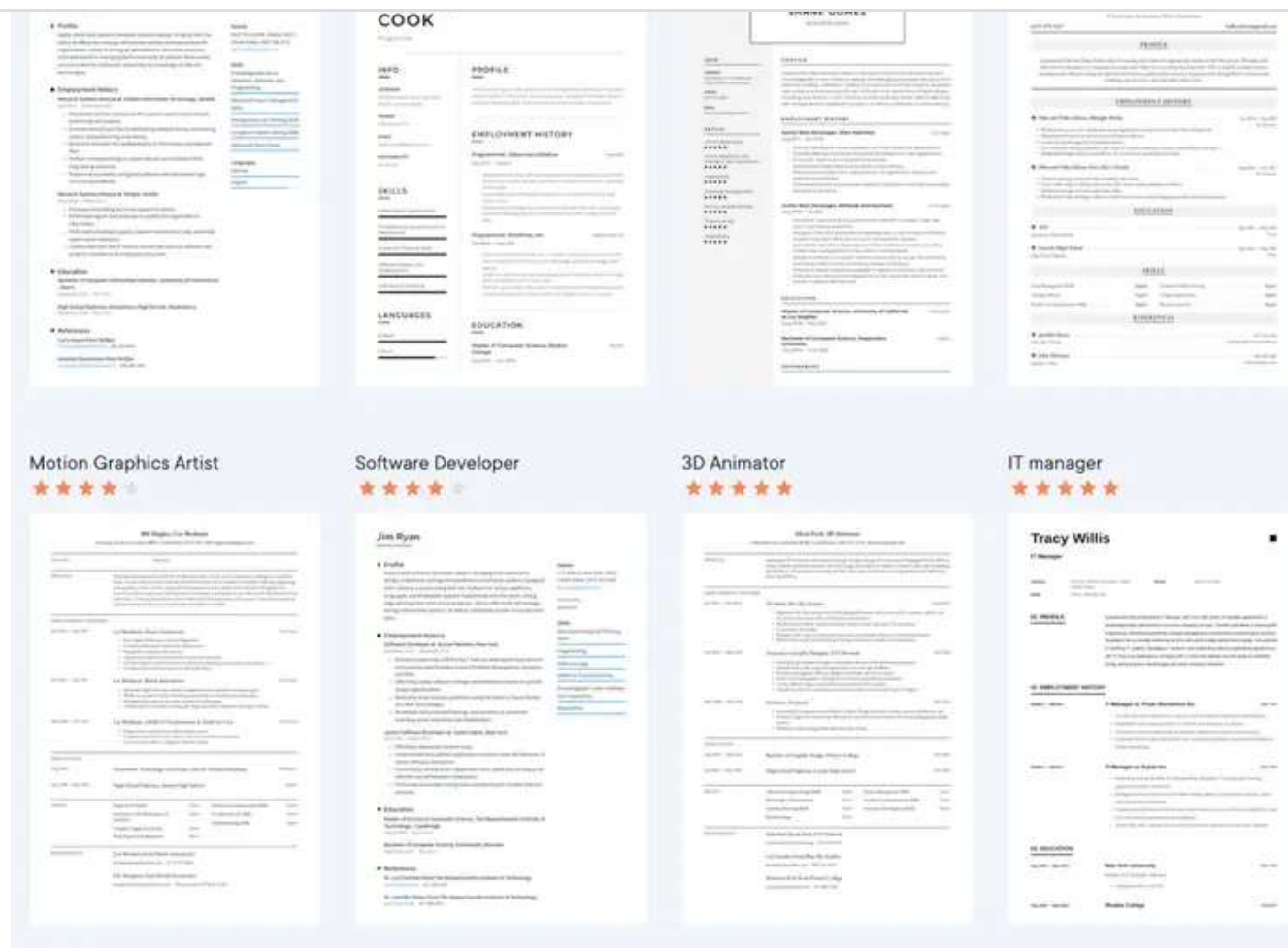
There are several resume generator sites, like resume.io, EnhanceCV, VisualCV, Resume Now, Europass and many more. Apart from Europass, all of these are paid solutions. In return for your money, they promise to generate resumes that are more professional and are proven to work. Their value proposition is that by using these services, you will increase your chances of getting your position.

Unfortunately, almost all resume generator sites work poorly for software developer resumes: and this is because they are optimized for resumes for everyone. Most sites try to cater from finance professionals to accounting, to teachers all the way to sales people. Take the example of resume.io and the range of professions they claim to cater for:

Select resume example category

All categories	277	Hospitality & Catering	17	Real Estate	10
Accounting & Finance	11	Human Resource	5	Retail	8
Administrative	9	Information Technology (IT)	10	Sales	9
Beauty & Wellness	7	Legal	6	Security & Protective Services	4
Business & Management	13	Maintenance & Repair	10	Social Work	11
Construction	3	Marketing	12	Sport & Fitness	18
Education	17	Medical	29	Transport & Logistics	8
Engineering	9	Other	27	Transportation	6
Government	3	Production	8		

Out of 277 resume templates, 10 are focused on tech, and 3 on software development. Still, as I reviewed all these templates, none were a choice I would strongly recommend as a technical hiring manager:



Tech resume templates on resume.io. They look nice from afar, but aren't great choices for developers. They almost all follow the hard to read two-column layouts and the template contents do not resemble anything in the real world.

Almost all resume sites use content writers to craft software developer resumes - and these resumes are not checked with engineering managers or recruiters in tech. This shows very clearly when you look at the specific examples. Take the Programmer resume example of resume.io:

Programmer

INFO

ADDRESS

1600 Amherst Way, Palo Alto,
94304, United States

PHONE

(315) 802-8179

EMAIL

taylor.cook@gmail.com

NATIONALITY

American

SKILLS

Performance Optimization

Troubleshooting and Solutions
Deployment

Analytical Thinking Skills

Software Design and
Development

Coding and Scripting

LANGUAGES

English

French

PROFILE

Innovative Programmer and Internet Entrepreneur striving to make the world a more unified and connected place. A creative thinker, adept in software development and working with various data structures.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Programmer, Johannes Initiative

Palo Alto

Dec 2015 — Present

- Worked to enhance software systems to help educators, scientists, and policy experts already working on some of humanity's greatest challenges.
- Developed and enhances programs to increase accuracy and lower costs.
- Developed strategies to ensure compliance with new standards.
- Handled debugging and troubleshooting with a high success rate.

Programmer, Kindlinks, Inc.

Menlo Park, CA

Feb 2004 — Sep 2015

- Since founding Kindlinks, Inc. in 2004 I continue to work to build and improve it's infrastructure, offerings, product strategy, and design.
- Work to continuously lead developments helping people to create, share, and discover in new ways.
- Remain up to date with current events around the globe, and aim to serve the people of the world with better ways to connect.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science, Boston College

Boston

Aug 2001 — Jun 2004

This resume template—supposedly created by professionals—has nothing to do with a software developer resume. It doesn't have a single programming language listed. Yet it has spoken languages on the template. The skills section doesn't even pass the buzzword bingo. And the template, with its two-column layout, is a poor choice for the resume.

The criteria of a decent resume generator site should be this:

1. **Resume templates optimized for hiring managers.** Are the templates created with the actual audience and easy readability in mind?
2. **Testimonials from real hiring managers.** While many resume generators and resume services claim that they'll help you score more callbacks, I would expect any paid solution to back this up with real hiring managers or recruiters in their industry.
3. **Real, successful resume examples.** Similar to testimonials from hiring managers, you should be vary of paying up, if a site doesn't showcase real—even if anonymized—resume examples that got people hired.

If and when you pay, the value proposition should be clear. What do you get for your money, beyond a PDF resume?

5. **Not quoting ATS myths and other false facts.** You can identify resume sites that try to sell resume templates and services without industry expertise. These sites typically quote things like "75% of resumes are never seen by humans" and other [ATS Myths](#) in order to upsell their service.

I've searched extensively among resume generator sites, and most do not satisfy these requirements for software developer resumes. In my search, I've uncovered one that does so: [Standard Resume](#). Not surprisingly, software engineers founded this site, built it for people in tech and in collaboration with technical hiring managers.

Standard Resume: By Developers, for Developers

[Standard Resume](#) is a resume generator site that lacks all the marketing promises that every other site does. However, they have what no other site has: real resume examples of software developers and engineering managers who used their service to craft resumes that got them jobs at the likes of Dropbox, Ebay, Facebook, Amazon and many others.

This resume site was founded by a group of techies working together at a SF startup. They used the MVP of the product to apply for jobs, and got offers from Dropbox and Metalab. In building the early version of Standard Resume, they wanted to solve for problems that no other resume generator on the market had an answer for:

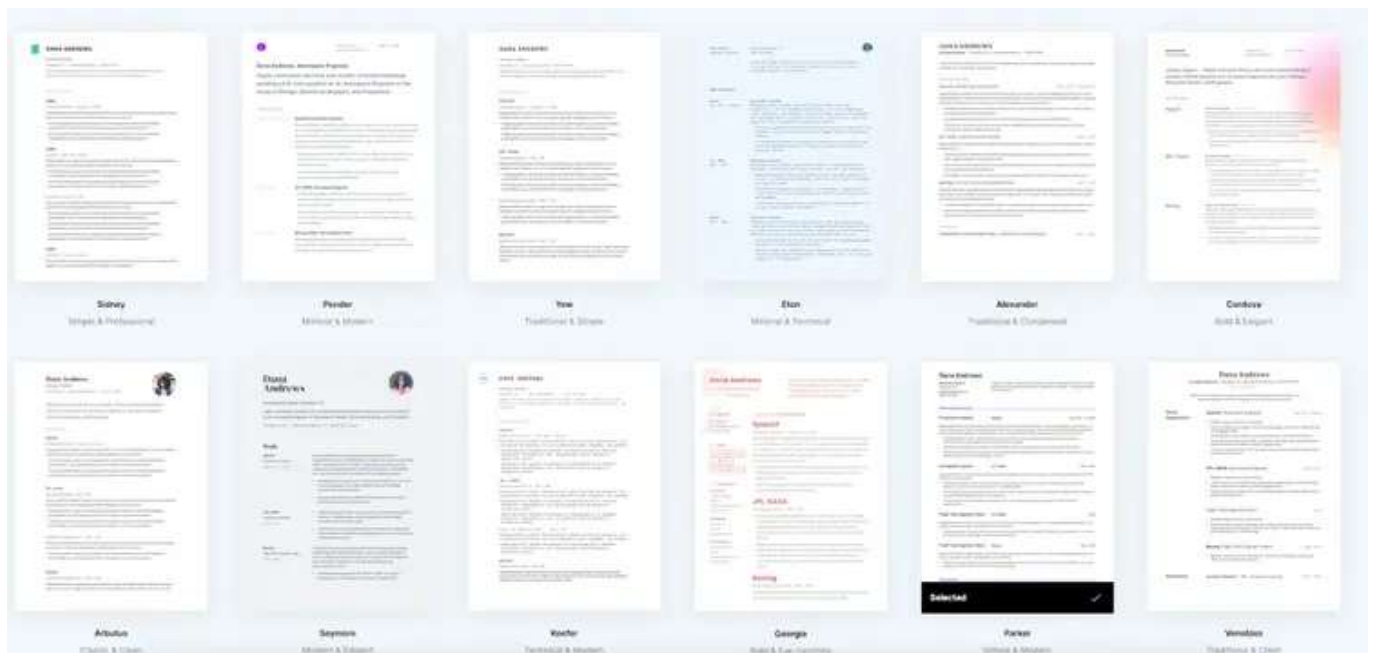
- **Generate both a web resume and a pdf one.** Sending over a PDF can be a hassle, especially when you are reaching out on LinkedIn. Standard Resume was built so you can send a link that renders your resume with the same layout as the PDF.
- **Track views of your (web) resume.** How can you tell if someone has read your resume? By tracking if they visited the link you sent over.
- **Import your details from LinkedIn** to your resume to make it quicker to build your CV.

I recommend using either [Standard Resume](#), or one of the templates below to build your resume. While Standard Resume is a paid subscription, the biggest benefits of it are these:

1. **The cleanest tech resume layouts I've seen.** You cannot "cram" the fonts, as UX professionals designed spacing for the resume templates. Almost everyone plays around with font sizes on templates, and the result is often a resume that feels crammed and unprofessional. I've had several people ask me if they can make the font size smaller on one of the other templates. With this solution, you need to worry about the content, not the design.
2. **A web-only resume version** that you can send over even before formally applying for a job. If you DM people, reach out on LinkedIn, you often can't send a PDF resume. But you can send a web link that has the same contents.

4. **Real resume examples of real developers and engineering managers** who actually got jobs at tech companies with that resume. Almost all other resume sites fail to show real developer resume examples of people working at well-known tech companies. With Standard Resume, you can [browse real resumes](#) for software engineers, iOS, frontend developers, data scientists, engineering managers and other professions who have successfully used the service.

It should be of little surprise that almost all Standard Resume templates are single-column and all templates have a heavy focus on spacing and typography—another thing that sets it apart from other sites. As a hiring manager, all of these layouts are easy—even pleasant—to read.



Resume templates from Standard Resume. Note that all but one follow the top-down template, with an easy-to-read structure and layout.

From the inside out: lessons learned from the founders of Standard Resume

Riley Tomasek is a software engineer and a cofounder of Standard Resume. After users have created more than 100,000 resumes - much of this for software developers - he shares lessons he's learned about what makes for a good resume in tech:

“One of the most common mistakes is cramming a ton of content into a single page. This is the number one issue I see with software engineering resumes. Removing the whitespace between paragraphs and sections makes your resume harder to scan and read. So do tiny font sizes.

The most important part of a resume is that it's easy to read. If the recruiter skips your resume because it's hard to read, nothing else—including the contents of your resume—matters. Either focus on the critical parts or make it two pages.

resume's first impression. Take the time to get the correct line length, font sizes, line heights, etc. — or let professionals handle it."

I came across Standard Resume while researching resume generator sites. I was about to close with the recommendation of *not* recommending any resume generators for tech resumes. However, the clean approach Standard Resume takes, and the easy to read templates made me change my mind. I reached out to the team, offering feedback on the resume templates, and listed things I missed from the existing ones. We collaborated and helped them create the Parker and Venables themes based on my existing resume templates. These two themes are ones that I would recommend for software engineers - and we'll review them in this chapter.

Template Reviews

In the second half of the chapter, we'll review both resume templates created for the book, as well as popular resume templates. The reviews all follow this format:

- **Link** to the template or site that provides the template.
- **Rating for software developers:** assessment on how well the template follows principles for good developer templates.
- **The good:** positive highlights on the resume format. Even if you don't use the template, you could take inspiration from the good parts.
- **The bad:** characteristics that could be a disadvantage when working with the template.
- **Ways to improve it:** ideas and suggestions on either improving or customizing the template.

Keep in mind that as most of these templates are popular, people likely had success with all of them, with the right content when applying for a position where they were a match for. The *content* of your resume is more important than the template itself.

Recommended Resume Templates

The following resume templates are all solid—and proven—choices for software engineers and engineering managers:

- The Pragmatic Engineer's resume template
- Standard Resume: Parker template
- The Mono Engineers' resume template
- Markdown to PDF resume template
- The Experienced Engineer's resume template
- Standard Resume: Venables template
- CareerCup resume template

The Pragmatic Engineer's Resume Template is a clean template that is a good choice to use for developers.

City, Country resume@pragmaticengineer.com	Gergely Orosz	linkedin.com/in/gergelyorosz github.com/gergelyorosz
Work Experience		
Senior Software Engineer Payments team	Uber Amsterdam, Netherlands	Sep 2018–Present
- Results, impact and your contribution. - Add at numbers to the impact, use active languages and mention specifics like the languages used. - The more recent the position, the more details you usually want to share. - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.		
Software Engineer II Customer Success team	Skyscanner London, UK	2017–2018
- Results, impact and your contribution - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.		
Software Developer	Skype London, UK	2015–2017
- Results, impact and your contribution - As the position is more in the past, you'll want to be mindful on how much details you add, and what you call out. You want to make sure there's space on all the key details on the first page.		
Software Developer Intern	LogMeIn Budapest, Hungary	Summer 2014
Results, impact and your contribution. The further in the past a position is, often the less important its details.		
Education and Certifications		
M.Sc. Computer Science, University of Munich, Germany. B.Sc. Computer Science, University of Technology, Budapest.		2013–2014 2010–2013
Technologies and Languages		
Languages: Java, Go, Swift, Kotlin, {other languages} Technologies: MySQL, Postgres, AWS, Git, {other technologies} Other: Data structures and algorithms, {other relevant skills}		

Rating for software developers: ★★★★★

The good:

- The template has many similarities to the Career Cup template, meaning US tech recruiters will find it familiar.
- Good use of bolding and consistent formatting makes the resume easy to scan.
- Dates and titles are *really* easy to read.
- The format works both for one- and two-page resumes.
- The template works well both with and without the summary section.

The bad:

- The template does not cater to people who would want to add more personal information. This can be customized, though.

Ways to improve it:

- Customize the highlight color and the fonts to your preferences.

The Parker resume template from Standard Resume is the “porting” of The Pragmatic Engineer’s Resume template to this resume builder. I collaborated with the Standard Resume team in building this template. I find this template slightly more readable and better formatted than The Pragmatic Engineer’s Resume Template, thanks to the touch up from the Standard Resume design team.

Gergely Orosz

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer	Uber (Amsterdam, NL)	Sep, 2018 - Current
- Results, impact and your contribution. - Add at numbers to the impact, use active languages and mention specifics like the languages used. - The more recent the position, the more details you usually want to share. - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.		
Software Engineer II	Skyscanner (London, UK)	2017 - Feb, 2018
- Results, impact and your contribution - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.		
Software Developer	Skype (London, UK)	2015 - 2017
- Results, impact and your contribution - As the position is more in the past, you'll want to be mindful on how much details you add, and what you call out. You want to make sure there's space on all the key details on the first page.		
Software Developer Intern	LogMeIn (Budapest, HU)	2014 - 2014
Results, impact and your contribution. The further in the past a position is, often the less important its details.		

Education

M.Sc. Computer Science	University of Munich (Germany)	2013 - 2014
B.Sc. Computer Science	University of Technology (Budapest, Hungary)	2010 - 2013

Technologies and Languages

Languages	Java, Go, Swift, Kotlin, {other languages}
Technologies	MySQL, Postgres, AWS, Git, {other technologies}
Other	Data structures and algorithms, {other relevant skills}

Rating for software developers: ★★★★★

The good:

- The template has many similarities to the Career Cup template, meaning US tech recruiters will find it familiar to scan.
- Crafted by designers, with a heavy emphasis on readability and spacing. The clarity shows: I find this template easier to scan than The Pragmatic Engineer’s Resume Template.
- A web version with the same layout can be shared with a link.
- Web resume views are tracked by the platform.
- The template works well when applying for US-companies.

The bad:

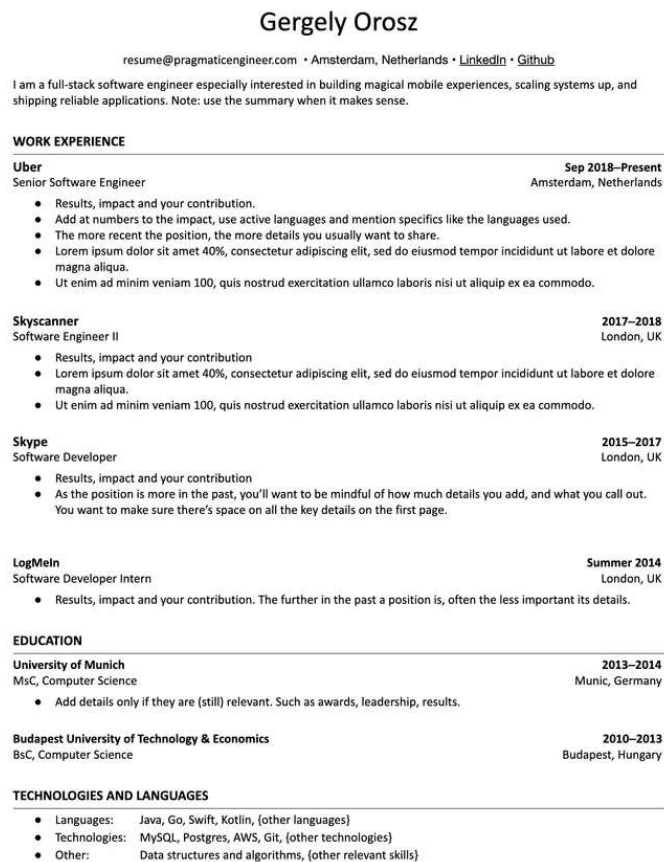
- Unlike a template, it’s harder to “cram” everything on one page. But this is by design.

Ways to improve it:

- Customize the highlight colors with the Standard Resume color picker.

The Mono Engineer's Resume Template

The Mono Engineer's Resume Template is a slight modification to the Pragmatic Engineer's Resume template.



Rating for software developers: ★★★★★

The good:

- It draws more attention to either the company or the job title.
- It can be a good fit for people who either have “standout” companies and education on their resume, or for people who have companies that recruiters and hiring managers are unlikely to recognize, and thus focusing on the titles makes more sense.
- The other good parts are the same as with The Pragmatic Engineer's Resume Template.

The bad:

- Add a highlight color and/or adjust fonts to your preferences.

Markdown to PDF Resume Template

[Markdown to PDF resume template generator](#) by Mike Lee Williams is a neat way to use Markdown as the source of truth for your resume and to store different versions on GitHub. The default style is similar to the Mono Engineer's Resume template, and you can customize it further.

RICHARD HENDRICKS	
richard.hendricks@mail.com • (912) 555-4321 • richardhendricks.example.com • San Francisco, CA	
CEO and Software Engineer with knowledge of applied information theory, including optimizing lossless compression schema of both the length-limited and adaptive variants.	
EXPERIENCE	
CEO/President, Pied Piper	Dec 2013 – Dec 2014
Pied Piper is a multi-platform technology based on a proprietary universal compression algorithm that has consistently fielded high Weisman Scores™ that are not merely competitive, but approach the theoretical limit of lossless compression.	
• Build an algorithm for artist to detect if their music was violating copyright infringement laws • Successfully won Techcrunch Disrupt • Optimized an algorithm that holds the current world record for Weisman Scores	
Teacher, CoderDojo	July 2013 – Dec 2013
Global movement of free coding clubs for young people.	
• Awarded 'Teacher of the Month'	
PROJECTS	
Miss Direction	Aug 2016
A mapping engine that misguides you:	
• Won award at AIHacks 2016 • Built by all women team of newbie programmers • Using modern technologies such as GoogleMaps, Chrome Extension and Javascript	
EDUCATION	
University of Oklahoma, BA Information Technology	2011 – 2014
• GPA 4.0 • DB1101 - Basic SQL • CS2011 - Java Introduction	
SKILLS	
• Web development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript • Compression: Mpeg, MP4, GIF	

Rating for software developers: ★★★★★

The good:

- A clean template.
- Markdown as the data source for the resume.
- Store different versions of your resume in GitHub (or another source)
- You get to build your resume from the command line!

The bad:

- Same as with The Mono Engineer's Resume Template.

Ways to improve it:

The Experienced Engineer's Resume Template

The Experienced Engineer's Resume Template is a template designed as a two-page template for experienced developers with standout experience. It works well for above senior candidates (principal, staff, distinguished engineers), people with standout companies on their resume, or for people with additional standout contributions (e.g. open source projects or contributions).

Gergely Orosz blog.pragmaticengineer.com Amsterdam, Netherlands • resume@pragmaticengineer.com • +1 23456 789		
I am a full-stack software engineer especially interested in building magical mobile experiences, scaling systems up, and shipping reliable applications. Note: use the summary when it makes sense.		
WORK EXPERIENCE	Uber, Senior Software Engineer Amsterdam, Netherlands	Sep 2018– Present
	- Results, impact and your contribution. - Add at numbers to the impact, use active languages and mention specifics like the languages used. - The more recent the position, the more details you usually want to share. - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.	
	Skyscanner, Software Engineer II London, UK	2017–2018
	- Results, impact and your contribution - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.	
	Skype, Software Developer London, UK	2015–2017
EDUCATION	LogMeIn London, UK	Summer 2014
	Results, impact and your contribution. The further in the past a position is, often the less important its details.	
	MSc Computer Science University of Munich. GPA: 4.0.	2013–2014
	BSc Computer Science Budapest University of Technology & Economics. Top 2% of the class.	2010–2013

Rating for software developers:

- With standout experience: ★★★★★
- Without this experience: ★★★☆☆

The good:

- Company name and title have stronger than usual attention.
- Dates are easy to scan.
- Links draw a lot of attention—and they do this deliberately. They are inviting the hiring manager or recruiter to click through and see strong content behind the links.

The bad:

- Technologies & languages will most likely be on the second page. This is deliberate: it is meant for standout profiles where recruiters will scan the second page as well, being impressed with either company names, title, or both.
- This template doesn't work well for people with less experience or people with few standout areas.

Ways to improve it:

- Make the color scheme your own.

Standard Resume Venables Template (Paid)

The Venables resume template from Standard Resume is the "porting" of The Experienced Engineer's Resume template to this resume builder. As with the Parker template, I also collaborated with Standard Resume in building it. I'm pleased with the result, which has better spacing than The Experienced Engineer's Resume Template and more color customization options.

Gergely Orosz

Work Experience	Uber (Amsterdam, NL) Senior Software Engineer	Sep, 2018 - Current
	- Results, impact and your contribution. - Add at numbers to the impact, use active languages and mention specifics like the languages used. - The more recent the position, the more details you usually want to share. - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.	
	Skyscanner (London, UK) Software Engineer II	2017 - Feb, 2018
	- Results, impact and your contribution - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet 40%, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. - Ut enim ad minim veniam 100, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo.	
	Skype (London, UK) Software Developer	2015 - 2017
	- Results, impact and your contribution - As the position is more in the past, you'll want to be mindful on how -much details you add, and what you call out. You want to make sure there's space on all the key details on the first page.	
	LogMeIn (Budapest, HU) Software Developer Intern	2014 - 2014
	Results, impact and your contribution. The further in the past a position is, often the less important its details.	
Education	University of Munich (Germany) M.Sc. Computer Science	2013 - 2014
	University of Technology (Budapest, Hungary) B.Sc. Computer Science	2010 - 2013
Technologies and Languages	Languages	Java, Go, Swift, Kotlin, {other languages}
	Technologies	MySQL, Postgres, AWS, Git, {other technologies}
	Other	Data structures and algorithms, {other relevant skills}

Rating for software developers:

- With standout experience: ★★★★★

- Same as with the Experienced Engineer's template.
- You need to fiddle less with tables than when using the Experienced Engineer's template, and you can't mess up the layout of this template.
- A web version with the same layout can be shared with a link.
- Web resume views are tracked by the platform.

The bad:

- Locations cannot be recorded separately for each position—I added this information to the company name field.

Ways to improve it:

- Customize the highlight colors with the Standard Resume color picker.

CareerCup Resume Template

The CareerCup resume template is common to see used both for Silicon Valley software engineers and people applying for tech companies in the US. The template was created by Gayle Laakmann McDowell, author of [Cracking the Coding Interview](#).

EMPLOYMENT		
Software Engineer, Intern	Apple Computer	Summer 2004
iChat AV		
- Reduced time to render the user's buddy list by 75% by implementing prediction algorithm. - Implemented iChat integration with OS X Spotlight Search by creating tool which extracts metadata from saved chat transcripts and provides metadata to a system-wide search database. - Redesigned chat file format and implemented backwards compatibility for search.		
Lead Student Ambassador	Microsoft Corporation	Fall 2003 – Spring 2005
- Promoted to Lead Student Ambassador in Fall 2004; supervised 10 – 15 Student Ambassadors. - Created and taught Computer Science course, CSE 099: Software Design and Development.		
Head Teaching Assistant	University of Pennsylvania	Fall 2001 – Spring 2005
- Courses: Advanced Java III, Software Engineering, Mathematical Foundations of Computer Science I & II. - Promoted to Head TA in Fall 2004; led weekly meetings and supervised four other TAs.		
Software Design Engineer, Intern	Microsoft Corporation	Summers 2001 – 2003
Visual Studio Core (Summer 2003)		
- Implemented a user interface for the VS open file switcher (ctrl-tab) and extended it to tool windows. - Created service to provide gradient across VS and VS add-ins. Optimized service via caching.		
Programmer Productivity Research Center (Summers 2001, 2002)		
- Built app to compute similarity of all methods in a code base; reduced time from $O(n^2)$ to $O(n \log n)$. - Created test case generation tool which creates random XML docs from XML Schema.		
EDUCATION		
Philadelphia, PA	University of Pennsylvania	Fall 2000 – May 2005
- M.S.E. in Computer and Information Science, May 2005. GPA: 3.6 - B.S.E. in Computer Science Engineering with Minor in Mathematics, May 2005. In-major GPA: 3.4. - Graduate Coursework: Software Foundations; Computer Architecture; Algorithms; Artificial Intelligence; Comparison of Learning Algorithms; Computational Theory. - Undergraduate Coursework: Operating Systems; Databases; Algorithms; Programming Languages; Comp. Architecture; Engineering Entrepreneurship; Calculus III.		
TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE		
Projects		
Multi-User Drawing Tool (2004). Electronic classroom where multiple users can view and simultaneously draw on a "chalkboard" with each person's edits synchronized. C++, MFC Synchronized Calendar (2003 – 2004). Desktop calendar with globally shared and synchronized calendars, allowing users to schedule meetings with other users. C#.NET, SQL, XML Operating System (2002). UNIX-style OS with scheduler, file system, text editor and calculator. C		
ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE AND AWARDS		
Instructor (2003 – 2005): Taught two full-credit Computer Science courses; average ratings of 4.8 out of 5.0. Third Prize, Senior Design Projects: Awarded 3rd prize for Synchronized Calendar project, out of 100 projects.		
LANGUAGES AND TECHNOLOGIES		
- C++, C, Java, Objective-C, C#.NET, SQL, JavaScript, XSLT, XML (XSD) Schema - Visual Studio; Microsoft SQL Server; Eclipse; XCode; Interface Builder		

Rating for software developers: ★★★★★☆

The good:

- Tech recruiters in the US are used to it.
- Consistent formatting of dates and company/school names across sections.
- Dates and titles are *really* easy to read. Figuring out how much experience you have is a breeze.
- The format can be used for two pages as well—just make sure the most important details that recruiters need to see are listed on the first page.

The bad:

- Dated style, using no colors. In 2014, when this template was created, resume printing was still a thing. This template has too much black-and-white.
- Geared towards top tech companies in the US. For other companies and outside the US, you'll need to tweak this.
- The format incentivizes crowding content on the same page.

Ways to improve it:

- The resume is dated in its black-and-white style. You could use colors to have headings stand out and reduce the bolding.

Other Resume Templates

There are other resume templates that are not great choices for a developer or engineering manager resume for different reasons. We'll look at the ones that I've seen most frequently used by people:

- Google Docs: Serif resume template
- Google Docs: Swiss resume template
- Canva resume templates
- Resume.io: software engineer template
- Resume.io: web developer template with skill points
- VisualCV: Standard template
- Enhancv: software engineer template
- Europass CV

Although I hesitate to recommend these templates, they could work well enough when addressing their drawbacks, or for certain use cases. Don't forget that the resume contents matter more than the template itself.

Let's review the templates, analyzing both the issues, as well as their strengths.

Google Docs Serif Resume Template

I am not a fan of two-column resumes, as they make it hard to scan from top to bottom and they squeeze the space you can add for your experiences. However, if you go with one, the [Google Docs Serif resume](#) is still an okay choice. It is not specific to software development, so I would change "Skills" to "Technologies" and remove the Awards / Languages.

is the order of the sections. Otherwise, this template is not a good choice for a software developer's resume.

Your Name Creative Director Skills Experience Education	Your Name 123 Your Street Your City, ST 12345 123.456.7890 no_reply@example.com Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aenean interdum nisi. Sed in consequat mi. Sed pulvinar lacinia felis eu f Company Name / Job Title MONTH 20XX - PRESENT, LOCATION Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aenean interdum nisi. Sed in consequat mi. Sed in consequat mi, sed pul lacinia felis eu finibus. Company Name / Job Title MONTH 20XX - MONTH 20XX, LOCATION Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aenean interdum nisi. Sed in consequat mi. Company Name / Job Title MONTH 20XX - MONTH 20XX, LOCATION Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aenean interdum nisi. Sed in consequat mi. Sed pulvinar lacinia felis eu f School Name / Degree MONTH 20XX - MONTH 20XX, LOCATION Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed dia nonummy nibh euismod tincidunt ut laoreet dolore. School Name / Degree MONTH 20XX - MONTH 20XX, LOCATION Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed dia nonummy nibh euismod tincidunt ut laoreet dolore.
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Rating for software developers: ★★☆☆☆

The good:

- Order of sections: skills (technologies/languages), work experience, then education. This order works well for software engineers.

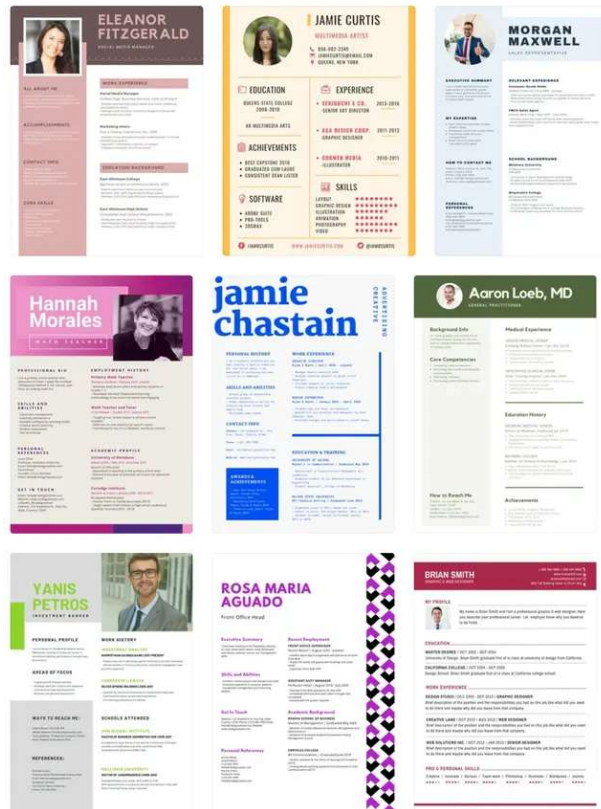
The bad:

- Lots of space wasted on the left side.
- Hard for recruiters to scan the dates for your work experience and education.

Ways to improve it:

- I advise not to use this template for software engineering positions.
- For experienced engineers, consider using the Experienced Engineer's Template or Standard Resume Venables template. Both offer a similar layout but better formatting.

If you have a subscription to Canva Pro, you have the option of using hundreds of resume templates, included in the subscription. I've done many of the illustrations in this book with Canva, and Canva is gaining more and more popularity, thanks to a good price-for-value monthly pricing.



Rating for software developers: From ★☆☆☆☆ to ★★★★★

The good:

- Probably the largest selection of resume templates in one place.
- If you are a Canva subscriber, it's worth checking out the selection.

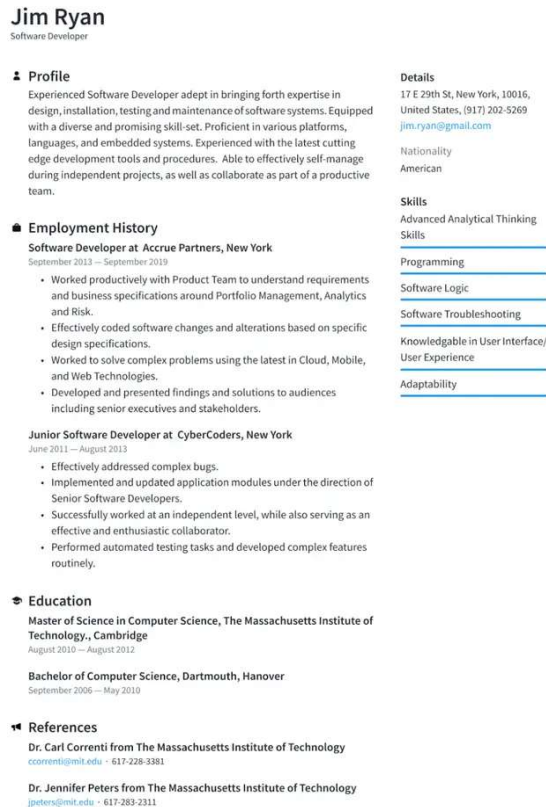
The bad:

- The selection for templates is overwhelming and it's hard to narrow down to ones that work for tech.
- Most resume templates are optimized for looks over content.
- Many templates come with photos: something you'll want to avoid.

Ways to improve it:

- There are decent templates with Canva: you just need to search more. Look for single-column ones that have clear formatting.

The Software Developer Resume template by resume.io is similar in style to the Google Docs Serif resume and it comes with the same issues as that one.



Rating for software developers: ★★☆☆☆

The good:

- A one-page resume.

The bad:

- The two-column layout limits the details you can share for your work experience.
- This resume breaks most guidelines in this guide. It does not have a Language and Technologies section—yet it has the unnecessary references section.
- The “Skills” and the blue line under them add noise for no reason.
- The “Skills” listed on this resume have nothing to with skills hiring managers and recruiters look for at tech companies.
- The example resume copy is a poor example for a software engineer and seems to have been written by someone who has not worked in software.

Ways to improve it:

Skills Points and the Resume.io Web Developer Template (Paid)

The [Web Developer Resume template](#) by resume.io is worth calling out for the pointed skills section—and why following skills scoring is not a great idea.



Rating for software developers: ★★☆☆☆☆

The good:

- A one-page resume.

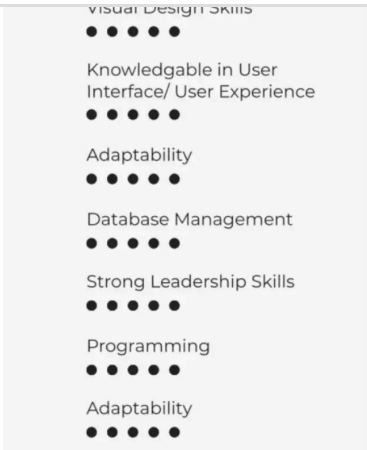
The bad:

- The two-column layout limits the details you can share for your work experience.
- Note how the two columns are swapped from the previous resume.io template. You might ask yourself: why? It is a great question: there seems to be little consistency in resume template principles for many of the resume generator sites.

Ways to improve it:

- I advise to not use this template for software engineering positions.

On the points system



Visual Design Skills
● ● ● ● ●

Knowledgeable in User
Interface/ User Experience
● ● ● ● ●

Adaptability
● ● ● ● ●

Database Management
● ● ● ● ●

Strong Leadership Skills
● ● ● ● ●

Programming
● ● ● ● ●

Adaptability
● ● ● ● ●

This resume template is an example of using the points system to “score” how strong you are in certain areas. However, here’s why this approach doesn’t work well:

- Anything you score yourself 3 points or lower out of 5 should likely not be on your resume. Why would you mention a technology in which you rate yourself at a low score?
- Anything mentioned as 4 or 5 stars is a given, without the star system as well. Recruiters and hiring managers will assume you are proficient with anything you list on your resume. Why else would you mention it?
- Your rating will likely be off anyway. I have seen people rate themselves as 5 stars on a language in which they seemed to not know things that I thought were basics. I’ve also had someone rate themselves 2 stars on a framework that they turned out to be solid at. People aren’t as good at rating themselves as they think they are—and experienced recruiters and hiring managers are very much aware of this.

Similar to how a profile photo won’t help your resume, star ratings can only work against you. Drop the ratings and keep all technologies relevant for the position that you are proficient with.

VisualCV Standard Template (Paid)

The [VisualCV standard template](#) shares a lot of the good with the CareerCup resume. It’s a solid alternative to that one—except for the fact that you have to pay to have the VisualCV branding removed.

Software Engineer

Summary

Software development engineer including four years of device driver development on all MS Windows operating systems. Expertise in the design and development of systems and software for high-speed data acquisition, process control and signal processing. Solid background in the technology of semiconductor devices, basic techniques of microelectronics, circuit design and analysis. Exceptional troubleshooting training and documentation skills.

Experience

Staff Software Engineer

2014 - Present

XYZ Company

Performed software design and development of hardware and the operation of specific sub-systems for the new Company SoftModem product.

- Ported SM56 SoftModem to various hardware platforms (PCI based, AC97 based) for all Windows operating systems (Win9x/WinMe, Windows NT/2000, Windows XP).
- Supported test and application engineers in testing and debugging the modem software.
- Identified product specific hardware / software quality requirements to pass Microsoft WHQL certification.
- Provided support to client companies and end-users in the USA, Germany and Taiwan.
- Designed a C++ class library for Windows / Linux cross-platform kernel driver development.
- Participated in new product design and development.

Systems Engineer

2010 - 2014

ABC Company

Charged with the design and development of software for PC based data acquisition boards. Supported customers in the development of their software applications. Provided support to test department, field application engineers and hardware design engineers.

- Designed and developed device drivers for PCI-bus based data acquisition boards for Windows 95/98 and Windows NT.
- Created an application programmer interface (API) for various data acquisition boards. Implemented API's in common function libraries (DLL's).
- Designed and wrote graphical user interfaces, application software and example programs.
- Developed and implemented LabVIEW virtual instrument libraries and Active-X controls.
- Designed and developed a function library for ABC Company C44 DSP processor board including the software interface and communication protocol between the DSP and host processor.
- Developed test procedures, test setup and software for final production tests as well as FCC and CE certification tests.
- Participated in the design, prototyping and testing of new analog and digital boards.

Education

Service Technician Certificate

2010 - 2011

Institute of Technology

Rating for software developers: ★★★☆☆

The good:

- Clean format and nice use of colors.
- A resume format that works well for two-page resumes.
- Highlights your job titles while still making dates easy to read.
- Clear separation of sections.

The bad:

- Black-and-white, not much use of colors.
- When using the free service, a logo is added to the resume, which makes your resume look cheap.

Ways to improve it:

- Add a "Technologies and Languages" section or something similar on the first page.
- Make the summary short. You could also just drop the name "Summary".
- Drop the title "Software Engineer". It's obvious and takes up space.

EnhanCV Software Engineer Resume (Paid)

I do not recommend the EnhanCV Software Engineer resume and am listing it here to showcase the dangers of resume sites that create resumes that job seekers find pretty. I listed this format as a cautionary example.

ALEX JOHNSON
10 years challenging the concepts of finance, aiming to shape the future through technology

https://www.enhancv.com San Francisco, CA

IT PROJECTS

World Best Drive Buddy
4/2019 - 7/2019
https://github.com/denaki/worldbestdrivebuddy
Full-stack Web application for sharing car journeys which allow for different people to join the same car ride/travel. The application enables both passengers and drivers to leave ratings, comments, feedback, etc.
• Used technologies: Java, Gradle, Hibernate, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, JWT, MySQL, MariaDB, HTML, CSS, JS, Bootstrap.

Worst Beers DataBase
4/2019 - 5/2019
A link can be provided upon request
Full-stack application of a database of beers from all over the world, showing their details and average rating, enabling users to manage all the beers that they have drank and/or want to drink.
• Being creative and seeking different approach we have crafted an application for the worst beers, not for the best.
• Used technologies: Java, Spring MVC, Gradle, Hibernate, Spring Data JPA, MySQL, MariaDB, HTML, CSS, JavaScript.

Kod Takoa
3/2019
https://github.com/ajangelov/teamwork-1-telerik-academy-work-item-management/blob/master/KodTakoa%20Presentation.pdf
Created a product with the brand "Kod Takoa", custom logo and product presentation. Console Application Developed as an OOP Teamwork.
• Work Item Management System that provides a single view into all data, files, tasks, actions, collaborations, and history, incident (Bug), service request (Story), or process (Feedback).

CORPORATE EXPERIENCE

Business Development Manager & IT Infrastructure Support
Amaze Corporate Events
8/2017 - 10/2019 Bulgaria
A leading team building and corporate events company in Bulgaria.
• Driving force behind generating new sales leads and contacts, boosted an increase in the customer database and revenue by 24% annually and upselling additional services to existing clients leading a team of 3 people.
• I have developed an excel based business simulation for the financial sector.
• Maintained Google for Business cloud infrastructure, corporate websites, configuring 20 workstations and introduced new Invoicing and project management systems.

LIFE PHILOSOPHY

"Aut inveniam viam aut faciam."
(I shall either find a way or make one)
Hannibal Barca

TOOLBOX

TECHNOLOGIES

Java	Spring MVC	MySQL	GIT
Hibernate	JavaScript	HTML	REST
Thymeleaf	CSS	JWT security	Gradle
Bootstrap	jQuery	Postman	

POWER SKILLS

Problem solving	Assertiveness
Creativity	Critical thinking
Presentation / Public speaking	Teamwork
Time management	Emotional intelligence

EDUCATION

Alpha Java Track
Telerik Academy
1/2019 - 7/2019 Sofia, Bulgaria

Rating for software developers: ★★☆☆☆

The good:

- Looks stunning—as a candidate, when you are looking at your own resume.

The bad:

- Technical hiring managers and recruiters won't appreciate the format as it's hard to scan.
- Encourages adding a photo—which leads to bias.
- Some sections make little sense. Life Philosophy adds little content.
- A two-column structure that makes it hard to scan for recruiters, and discourages adding sufficient details for your experience.

- Power Skills are something you probably don't want on your CV: they're empty buzzwords.
- Only use this template if you can definitely fit everything on one page.
- Customize the right column and try to make good use of it. I'd remove "Life Philosophy", rename Toolbox to "Skills" and have a "Languages" and a "Technologies" section.

EuroPass CV

Avoid this CV template in applying for tech jobs. The biggest sin of this format is encouraging adding all the details that lead to biases: photos, birth dates, gender, and so on. The Europass format is also *not* required to apply to jobs in Europe—contrary to what some people incorrectly assume.

Every tech recruiter I've spoken with advised to not use this format - and I advise the same. The Europass format was created by a working group within the European Commission. Though I could not confirm this officially, several recruiters mentioned hearing that there was no recruiter, HR specialist or job seeker in this committee.

